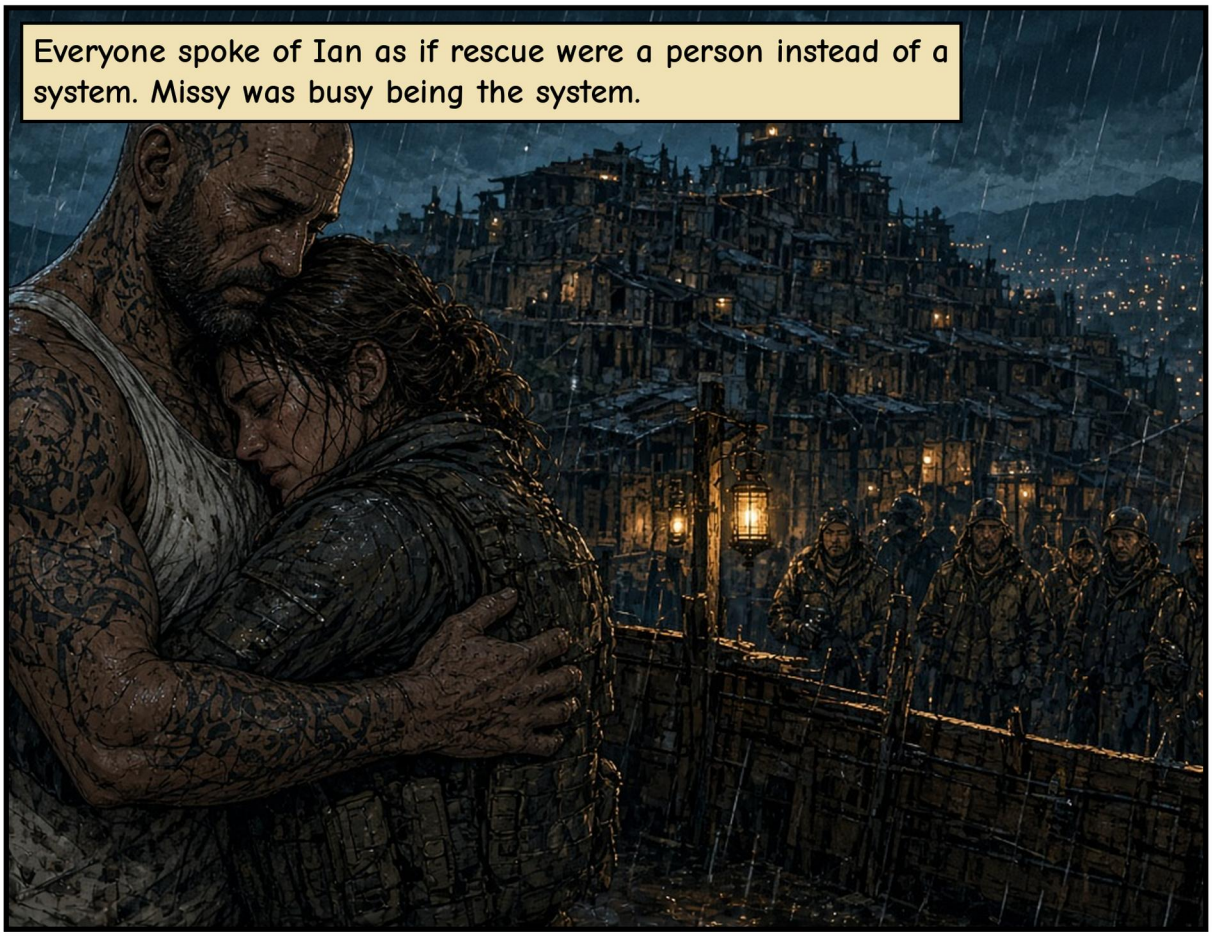
SOLACE

THE LIGHT STAYS ON



CHAOTIC DESIGNS

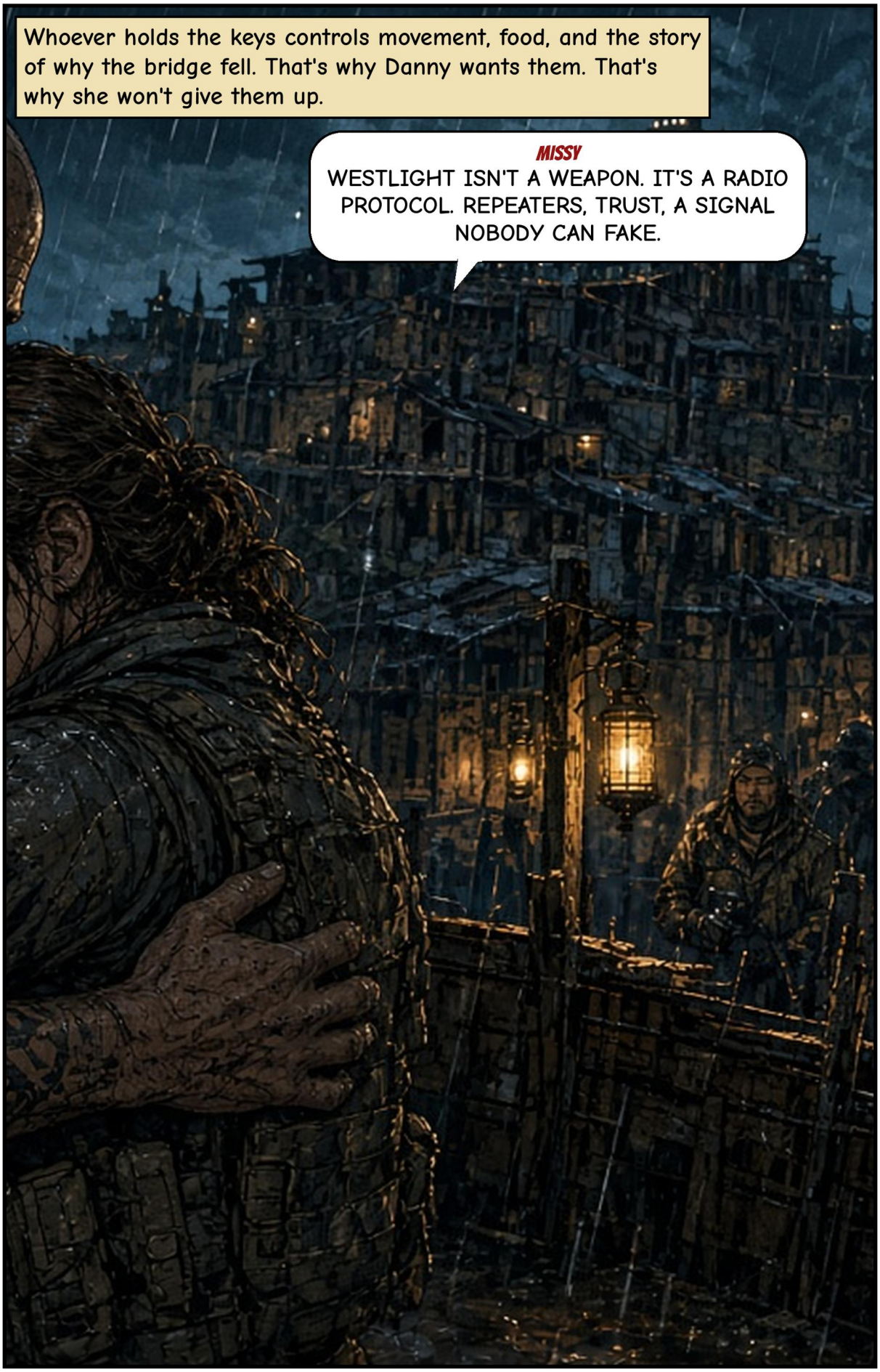
ISSUE #4


Everyone spoke of Ian as if rescue were a person instead of a system. Missy was busy being the system.


He crossed nine districts of dark to save her. She was saving people when he got there.


IAN
I MADE IT.
MISSY
SO DID THEY.


MISSY
YOU CAN HOLD ME AFTER WE KEEP THE EAST BLOCK ALIVE.
IAN
...WHAT DID THEY DO TO YOU... NO. TELL ME WHERE IT GOES.


Whoever holds the keys controls movement, food, and the story of why the bridge fell. That's why Danny wants them. That's why she won't give them up.
MISSY
WESTLIGHT ISN'T A WEAPON. IT'S A RADIO PROTOCOL. REPEATERS, TRUST, A SIGNAL NOBODY CAN FAKE.


SARA
A RESCUE TIPS HIM. HE SMELLS IT, HE MOVES THE CHARGES.
IAN
I'M NOT LEAVING YOU THERE.
SARA
SOME PEOPLE YOU SAVE BY LEAVING.


MISSY
IF IT GOES WRONG, YOU RUN THAT CORRIDOR. DON'T WAIT FOR HIM.
SARA
YOU LOVE HIM.
MISSY
YES. GO SAVE YOURSELF.


He could stay only for her. Or stay because her work had become his. The difference would decide how the city fought, and how it ended.
IAN
BOATS. WE COULD GO BY WATER.
MISSY
BOATS CARRY INFECTION. AND THOUSANDS STAY.


KEITH
EVERY NAME MATTERS, IAN. EVEN THE ONES NOBODY'S LEFT TO SAY.
IAN
THEN WE CARRY THEM. ALL OF THEM. EVEN ME.


KEITH
MARCUS. YOUR MOTHER TAUGHT YOU TO READ AT THE KITCHEN TABLE. DANIEL, YOU SANG IN THE...


KEITH
DON'T LET THEM BE PENCIL.


After that night the districts stopped being helpers. They became an army. And the operation had a witness.


TO BE CONTINUED...